

CHAPTER 32: STAFF MANAGEMENT

Comprehensive Excellence Revision Guide & Active Recall Portfolio

A highly structured pedagogical toolkit mapping the entire Year 4 Tunisian Secondary Education syllabus for Chapter 32: Staff Management. Designed specifically to build analytical capacity, reinforce advanced grammar, master phonetical stress shifts, and guarantee maximum marks on the National Baccalaureate Exam.

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I. EXHAUSTIVE COURSE THEORY

In-depth lexical analysis of staff management, advanced grammar of Parallel Structures, and phonetical stress shifts.

II. ACTIVE RECALL REPOSITORY

Exactly 40 high-yield exam questions and answers in a dual-column layout for immediate self-testing.

III. EXAM EVALUATION QUIZ

A 10-question diagnostics test including MCQs and True/False justifications matching Tunisian exam formats.

IV. SUMMARY MEMO SCHEMES

Step-by-step structural formulas, conversion sheets, and word-stress guides for active review.

Official Domain: mathbacai.com | **Designed for:** Year 4 Baccalaureat (All Sections)

PART 1: THE EXHAUSTIVE COURSE THEORY

1. Analytical & Theoretical Context

Staff Management represents a cornerstone sub-theme of Unit 4 (Life Issues), exploring the complex relationship between corporate entities, employer responsibilities, employee rights, and labor market dynamics. For Year 4 Baccalaureate students, the topic transcends simple corporate jargon to analyze the human, social, and moral values associated with work. It focuses on several key socio-economic debates: the balance between company survival (cost efficiency, outsourcing, automation) and employee livelihood; the ethical boundaries of employee dismissal (unfair sacking versus economic redundancy); the physical and mental tolls of the modern workforce (overwork, lack of work-life balance, and unpaid overtime); and the indispensable role of **Trade Unions** in advocating for safe working conditions, fair wages, and collective bargaining rights.

Students are expected to critically evaluate authentic texts depicting real-world scenarios, such as mass layoffs due to company down-sizing, workers going on strike to protect their pension plans, and progressive human resource initiatives offering extensive perks to retain high-performance personnel.

2. Thematic Vocabulary Portfolio (Essential Bac Terms)

To score full marks on vocabulary matching, cloze texts, and word derivation questions, students must acquire and master this precise lexical range, including exact definitions, word parts, and synonyms:

Vocabulary Term	Grammar Part & API Phonetics	Academic Definition (Grounded)	Synonyms / Context
Sacked	Adjective / Verb (past) /sækt/	Dismissed from employment immediately, typically due to misconduct, poor performance, or structural changes.	Dismissed, Fired, Terminated
Redundant	Adjective /rɪ'dʌn.dənt/	Laid off because the position is no longer required by the company (due to downsizing, restructuring, or technology).	Laid off, Superfluous, Surplus
Overtime	Noun / Adverb /'əʊ.və.taɪm/	Time worked in addition to one's scheduled working hours. Often compensated at higher premium rates.	Extra hours, Supplemental labor
Perks	Noun (plural) /pɜ:ks/	Non-wage benefits provided by employers (e.g., company cars, private health insurance, gym memberships).	Fringe benefits, Incentives
Overworked & Underpaid	Adjectival idiom /,əʊ.və'wɜ:kt/	The status of being subjected to excessive workloads while receiving disproportionately low financial compensation.	Exploited, Burdened
Trade Union	Compound Noun /treɪd 'ju:ni.ən/	An organized association of workers in a trade, group of trades, or profession, formed to protect their rights and interests.	Labour union, Workers' syndicate

Vocabulary Term	Grammar Part & API Phonetics	Academic Definition (Grounded)	Synonyms / Context
Resign	Verb (transitive) /rɪˈzaɪn/	To voluntarily leave a job, office, or position through formal notification to the employer.	Quit, Step down, Relinquish
Recruit	Verb / Noun /rɪˈkruːt/	To actively enlist, select, and hire new personnel to join a company, service, or organization.	Hire, Employ, New intake
Breadwinner	Noun /'bred,wɪn.ər/	The primary financial earner whose wages sustain and support the entire household unit.	Household provider, Earner

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3. Advanced Grammar: Parallelism (Parallel Structures)

Parallelism is a critical syntactic rule evaluated on the Baccalaureate exam, particularly within sentence completion, editing, and essay writing. It dictates that elements of equal grammatical rank, importance, or function within a sentence must be expressed using identical grammatical forms. If the first item in a list or series is a gerund (V-ing), subsequent items must also be gerunds; if the first is an infinitive (to + verb), the others must be infinitives. This syntactic symmetry enhances flow, coherence, and professional reading rhythm.

EXAM GOLDEN RULE: Parallelism is triggered by coordinating conjunctions (and, but, or), correlative conjunctions (not only... but also, either... or, neither... nor, both... and), and comparative linkers (rather than, as well as, compared to). Always identify the starter verb or part of speech to align all subsequent components.

The Three Core Parallel Patterns for the Bac Exam:

Pattern	Incorrect	Correct	Grammatical Explanation
Coordinating Lists Gerund + Gerund + And + Gerund	Our company values recruiting talent, training employees, and to retain skilled workers.	Our company values recruiting talent, training employees, and retaining skilled workers.	All three elements in the coordinate list must be Gerunds (V-ing) acting as direct objects of the verb 'values'.
Correlative Alignment Not only [form] + But also [same form]	He was determined not only to obtain a raise but also gaining better working hours.	He was determined not only to obtain a raise but also to gain better working hours.	The elements following 'not only' and 'but also' must match exactly as infinitives (to + verb).
Comparative Parallelism [Form A] + Rather than + [Form B (same)]	She preferred working overtime for extra perks rather than to take unpaid leave.	She preferred working overtime for extra perks rather than taking unpaid leave.	Since the first comparative element is a Gerund ('working'), the second must align as a Gerund ('taking').

4. Phonetics Module: Derivational Stress Shifts & Pronunciation

Baccalaureate phonetics tests frequently target word stress shifts during derivation, as well as silent letters and suffix endings. Modern workplace terms are highly susceptible to shifting their tonic accent depending on their noun, verb, or adjective suffix form.

Base Verb / Word	Noun / Derived Form	Accent Change & Syllabic Stress Rule	IPA Transcription
EM-employ (1st)	em-PLOY-ee (3rd)	The stress shifts from the first syllable in the verb to the third syllable in the personal noun ending in '-ee'.	/ɪmˈplɔɪ/ → /ɪmˌplɔɪˈiː/
re-DUN-dant (2nd)	re-DUN-dan-cy (2nd)	The stress remains on the second syllable, but the word gains an extra syllable in its abstract noun form.	/rɪˈdʌn.dənt/ → /rɪˈdʌn.dən.si/

Base Verb / Word	Noun / Derived Form	Accent Change & Syllabic Stress Rule	IPA Transcription
dis-MISS (2nd)	dis-MIS-sal (2nd)	The stress remains fixed on the second syllable of the root verb when adding the suffix '-al'.	/dɪs'mɪs/ → /dɪs'mɪs.əl/
re-CRUIT (2nd)	re-CRUIT-ment (2nd)	The stress remains fixed on the second syllable of the root verb when creating the nominal form.	/rɪ'kru:t/ → /rɪ'kru:t.mənt/
SA-la-ry (1st)	SA-la-ried (1st)	Stress is fixed on the first syllable in both the noun and the derived adjective ending in '-ied'.	/'sæl.ər.i/ → /'sæl.ər.id/

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5. Writing Methodology: The Argumentative Paragraph

For Chapter 32, students are commonly asked to write a paragraph arguing for or against certain workplace practices, such as mandatory overtime, or defending the rights of employees to strike. To achieve an 'A' grade, the paragraph must strictly employ **parallel structures** and **cohesive devices**.

MODEL PARAGRAPH (12 LINES) — THE VALUE OF BALANCED WORK LABOUR:

In the contemporary industrial era, maintaining fair labor practices is not only ethical but also highly productive. Progressive organizations have realized that overworking employees, denying fair overtime wages, and neglecting work-life balance always result in catastrophic turn-over rates. When managers focus on **recruiting** qualified talent, **training** workers properly, and **nurturing** their careers through standard perks, collective performance skyrockets. Conversely, when employees are constantly subjected to unfair dismissal or threatened with immediate sacking, they lose all professional motivation. To avoid costly legal disputes and to prevent disruptive worker strikes, companies must collaborate with Trade Unions. In the end, a company's financial success is more closely tied to treating workers humanely than to exploiting their daily labor.

6. Data Visualization Analysis

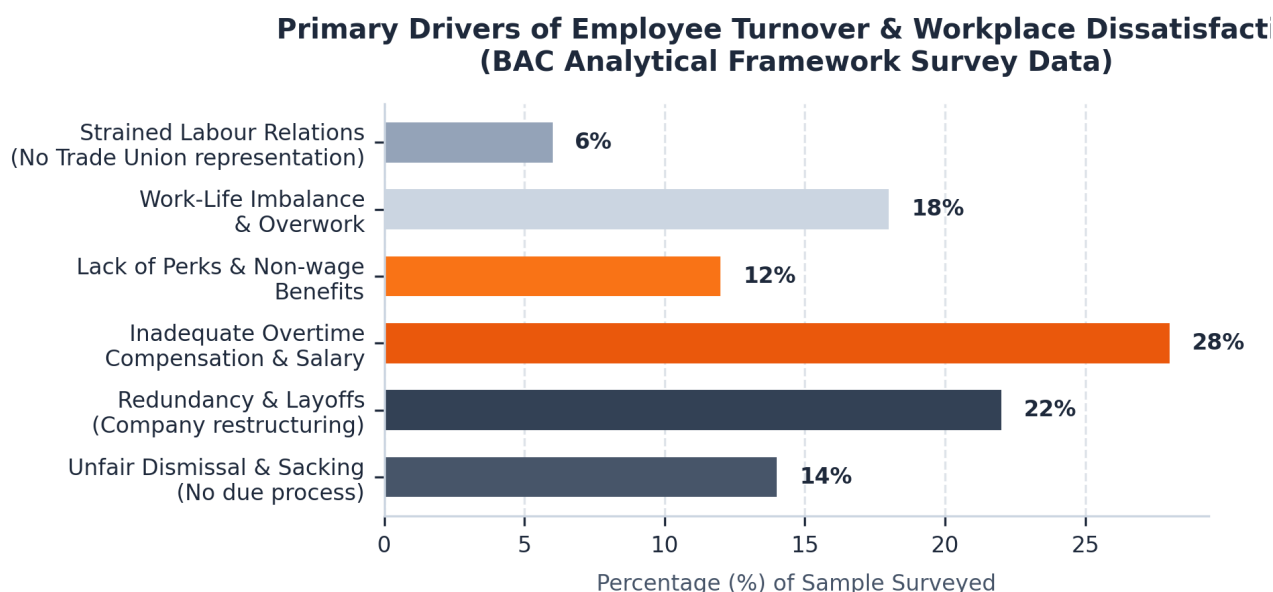


Figure 1.1: Primary drivers of workplace turnover and employee dissatisfaction. Source: mathbacai.com Year 4 Bac Revision Database.

ANALYTICAL DECODING (SO WHAT?): The data indicates that **financial and workload factors** (Inadequate Overtime Compensation & Salary at 28%, and Overwork & Imbalance at 18%) constitute the vast majority (46%) of employee attrition drivers. This demonstrates that traditional wage compensation alone is no longer sufficient; modern employees require structured perks and balanced hours to prevent burnout and subsequent resignation. For Baccalaureate reading comprehension, always link the lack of perks and excessive overtime directly to the decline of worker productivity.

PART 2: THE ACTIVE RECALL REPOSITORY

Use this double-column active recall grid to study. Cover the right column and try to answer each question from memory. Every question maps directly to Bac exam patterns.

Question Prompt	Exemplary Answer (Bac Standard)
Q1: What is the main difference between being sacked and being made redundant?	Being sacked is due to employee misconduct or poor performance (it is punitive). Being made redundant occurs when the employer no longer needs the job position due to downsizing, technology, or financial losses.
Q2: Define the term 'overtime' and explain how it is typically compensated.	Overtime refers to extra hours worked beyond normal contract hours. It is usually paid at a higher premium rate (e.g., time-and-a-half or double-time) as defined by labor laws.
Q3: What are 'perks' in a professional context? Give three examples.	Perks (fringe benefits) are non-wage compensations. Examples include: private health insurance, company cars, and flexible working schedules.
Q4: Translate and explain the phrase 'overworked and underpaid'.	Surchargé de travail et sous-payé. It describes workers subjected to excessive labor demands without receiving fair or adequate wages in return.
Q5: What is the core role of a 'Trade Union' in staff management?	A Trade Union represents and protects workers' collective rights, negotiates fair wages, ensures workplace safety, and organizes strikes if collective bargaining fails.
Q6: What does 'to recruit' mean in business operations?	It means to actively seek, screen, interview, select, and hire new employees to fill vacant positions within an organization.
Q7: Define 'breadwinner' and state its social relevance.	The breadwinner is the primary earner who provides financial sustenance for the family, especially critical in economic discussions about wage sufficiency.
Q8: What is 'unfair dismissal' under labour laws?	It is when an employee is sacked without a fair, legal, or justifiable reason, or without following the mandatory legal procedures of due process.
Q9: What is the difference between 'to resign' and 'to retire'?	To resign is to voluntarily leave a job at any point in a career. To retire is to leave the workforce permanently, typically upon reaching the legal age limit.
Q10: What does 'remittances' mean in the context of working abroad?	Remittances are sums of money earned by migrant workers and sent back to their home countries to support their families.

Question Prompt	Exemplary Answer (Bac Standard)
Q11: State the rule of parallelism regarding coordinating conjunctions.	Elements joined by and, but, or must have the same grammatical form (e.g., all nouns, all adjectives, all gerunds, or all infinitive phrases).
Q12: Correct this sentence: 'He likes hiring new staff, training them, and to write reports.'	Correct: 'He likes hiring new staff, training them, and writing reports.' (Aligns all as gerunds).
Q13: Correct this sentence: 'The strike was not only about raising wages but also to protect pensions.'	Correct: 'The strike was not only about raising wages but also about protecting pensions.' (Aligns gerunds after prepositions).
Q14: Complete: 'A trade union's duty is both to negotiate fair salaries and... (protect) worker rights.'	Correct: '...both to negotiate fair salaries and to protect worker rights.' (Aligns the infinitives).
Q15: Aligns this list: 'Workplace hazards include slipping on wet floors, falling from heights, and... (breathe) toxic fumes.'	Correct: '...and breathing toxic fumes.' (Aligns with the 'V-ing' gerund structure).
Q16: Correct this: 'The company decided to outsource production rather than cutting salaries.'	Correct: 'The company decided to outsource production rather than to cut salaries.' (Aligns infinitives after comparison).
Q17: How do you identify a parallelism error in a sentence containing 'neither... nor'?	Check the grammatical structure immediately following 'neither' and ensure it matches the structure immediately following 'nor' exactly.
Q18: Correct: 'Neither the manager's attitude nor how the supervisors behaved was professional.'	Correct: 'Neither the manager's attitude nor the supervisors' behavior was professional.' (Aligns parallel noun phrases).
Q19: Aligns: 'The supervisor spent the day listening to complaints, writing memos, and... (dismiss) staff.'	Correct: '...and dismissing staff.' (Aligns gerunds).
Q20: Correct: 'In the office, she is quick at responding to emails and she organizes files well.'	Correct: 'In the office, she is quick at responding to emails and organizing files.' (Aligns both as parallel prepositional gerunds).

Question Prompt	Exemplary Answer (Bac Standard)
Q21: Where is the primary stress in 'employ' vs 'employee'?	In the verb 'em PLOY ', the stress is on the 2nd syllable. In the personal noun 'employ EE ', it shifts to the 3rd syllable (/ɪmˌplɔɪ'i:/).
Q22: Where is the primary stress in 'redundant' vs 'redundancy'?	The stress is fixed on the 2nd syllable for both: re DUN dant and re DUN dancy (/rɪˈdʌn.dəns.i/).
Q23: Identify the stressed syllable in 'dismissal'.	The stress is on the 2nd syllable: dis MISS al (/dɪs'mɪs.əl/).
Q24: What is the derived noun from the verb 'recruit' and where is its stress?	The noun is 're CRUIT ment'. The stress is on the 2nd syllable (/rɪ'kru:t.mənt/).
Q25: What is the word stress rule for nouns ending in the suffix '-tion' or '-sion'?	The primary stress falls on the penult (the second syllable from the end), e.g., resig NA tion (/ˌrez.ɪg'neɪ.ʃən/).
Q26: Classify the pronunciation of final '-ed' in: sacked, redundant, and dismissed.	1. Sacked → /t/ (ends in voiceless /k/) 2. Redundant → /ɪd/ (ends in /t/) 3. Dismissed → /t/ (ends in voiceless /s/)
Q27: Identify the silent letters in these work words: 'resigning' and 'mortgage'.	In 'resig ni ng', the letter ' g ' is silent (/rɪ'zaɪn.ɪŋ/). In 'mort g age', the letter ' t ' is silent (/ˈmɔː.gɪdʒ/).
Q28: Where is the stress in 'applicant'?	The stress is on the 1st syllable: AP plicant (/ˈæp.lɪ.kənt/).
Q29: Explain the stress shift in 'administer' vs 'administration'.	In 'ad MIN ister', stress is on the 2nd syllable. In 'adminis TRA tion', it shifts to the 4th syllable due to the '-tion' suffix.
Q30: Identify the primary stress in 'compensatory'.	The stress is on the 2nd syllable: com PEN satory (/kəm'pen.sə.tər.i/).

Question Prompt	Exemplary Answer (Bac Standard)
Q31: What are the main arguments in favor of worker strikes?	Strikes exert economic pressure on employers to negotiate, correct unfair work environments, and draw public attention to worker exploitation.
Q32: What are the negative consequences of high employee turnover on a company?	High turnover increases recruitment and training costs, disrupts workflow, lowers overall productivity, and degrades team morale.
Q33: How does 'redundancy' impact an individual's mental and financial health?	It leads to a sudden loss of income (financial distress), triggers feelings of inadequacy, and increases anxiety regarding future re-employability.
Q34: Give three cohesive devices used to express addition in an essay.	Furthermore, In addition, Moreover, and Beside.
Q35: Write a thesis statement about the importance of work-life balance.	Maintaining a healthy work-life balance is crucial because it boosts employee productivity, prevents clinical burnout, and fosters long-term career satisfaction.
Q36: Explain the term 'labor dispute'.	A formal disagreement between an employer and employees (or their trade union) regarding wages, working conditions, benefits, or union contract terms.
Q37: What does it mean to be 'blacklisted' in an industry?	To be placed on a list of workers who are disapproved of and systematically blocked from getting employment, often as a punishment for trade union activism.
Q38: Why do companies outsource their labor?	To reduce operational costs by hiring external foreign labor in regions where wages and manufacturing regulations are significantly cheaper.
Q39: How does the presence of a trade union affect labor productivity?	By resolving worker grievances, ensuring safety, and providing stable job security, unions reduce attrition and improve workers' long-term focus and productivity.
Q40: Correct: 'The staff complained not only about working long hours but also they had low pay.'	Correct: 'The staff complained not only about working long hours but also about receiving low pay.' (Aligns prepositional gerunds perfectly).

PART 3: EXAM EVALUATION QUIZ

1. Diagnostic Diagnostic Test (10 Questions)

Complete this exam-style quiz. Be careful with parallel structures and phonetic stress shifts.

Q1 [MCQ]: The CEO was praised for _____ talent, training employees, and motivating the staff.

A) to recruit | B) recruiting | C) recruit | D) having recruited

Q2 [MCQ]: The redundant workers decided to sue the corporation for unfair dismissal rather than _____ a strike.

A) organizing | B) to organize | C) organize | D) of organizing

Q3 [MCQ]: In the personal noun employee, the primary stress falls on the _____ syllable.

A) first | B) second | C) third | D) fourth

Q4 [MCQ]: Choose the word with a silent letter:

A) redundant | B) dismissal | C) resigning | D) salary

Q5 [MCQ]: Select the word where the final -ed is pronounced as /ɪd/:

A) sacked | B) redundant | C) dismissed | D) recruited

True / False Justification Section:

Q6 [VRAI/FAUX]: The suffix -tion always shifts the primary stress to the syllable immediately preceding it. (e.g., resign → resignation).

Justification: _____

Q7 [VRAI/FAUX]: Parallelism is optional when using correlative conjunctions like 'neither... nor'.

Justification: _____

Q8 [VRAI/FAUX]: A worker who is 'sacked' receives the same severance package and benefits as a worker made 'redundant'.

Justification: _____

Q9 [VRAI/FAUX]: In the compound noun 'overtime', the primary stress falls on the second word 'time'.

Justification: _____

Q10 [VRAI/FAUX]: The expression 'overworked and underpaid' acts as an adjectival idiom in Bac essays.

Justification: _____

2. Pedagogical Corrections & Explanations

Question	Detailed Pedagogical Correction & Exam Rule
Q1 Correction	Correct Answer: B (recruiting). Syntax Rule: The sentence contains a coordinating list ('_____ talent, training employees, and motivating...'). To maintain syntactic parallelism, the missing verb must match the gerund form 'V-ing' of the other items.
Q2 Correction	Correct Answer: A (organizing). Syntax Rule: The comparison operator 'rather than' links the initial action ('suing' implied after 'for') or the direct gerund 'organizing' to align with parallel comparative preferences. Gerund is preferred.
Q3 Correction	Correct Answer: C (third). Phonetic Rule: In personal nouns ending in '-ee' (like employee, trainee, referee), the primary stress shifts to the suffix itself on the 3rd syllable: /ɪmˌplɔɪˈiː/.
Q4 Correction	Correct Answer: C (resigning). Phonetic Rule: In 'resigning', the consonant 'g' is completely silent (/rɪˈzaɪn.ɪŋ/). All other options have fully pronounced consonants.
Q5 Correction	Correct Answer: D (recruited). Phonetic Rule: The final '-ed' is pronounced as /ɪd/ only after base verbs ending in the sounds /t/ or /d/. Hence, 'recruit' → 'recruited' (/rɪˈkruːtɪd/). 'Sacked' → /t/, 'dismissed' → /t/.
Q6 Correction	Correct Answer: TRUE. Explanation: The suffix '-tion' or '-sion' always forces the primary stress onto the syllable preceding it (the penult). E.g., re-sign (/rɪˈzaɪn/) → re-sig-NA-tion (/ˌrez.ɪɡˈneɪ.ʃən/).
Q7 Correction	Correct Answer: FALSE. Explanation: Parallelism is non-negotiable and strictly mandatory when using correlative conjunctions like 'neither... nor'. Failure to align structures results in immediate grammatical penalty on the exam.
Q8 Correction	Correct Answer: FALSE. Explanation: Sacking is punitive (due to fault), resulting in loss of benefits and negative references. Redundancy is non-punitive (economic), legally requiring severance compensation and positive employer references.
Q9 Correction	Correct Answer: FALSE. Explanation: In compound nouns (like overtime, footprint, classroom), the primary stress falls on the first element , i.e., O-ver-time (/ˈəʊ.və.taɪm/).
Q10 Correction	Correct Answer: TRUE. Explanation: 'Overworked and underpaid' functions as an adjectival idiom to describe workforce exploitation and is a highly valued lexical combination in essay writing.

SUMMARY MEMO SCHEMES (MEMOS D'EXCELLENCE)

Tableau M mo 1.1: Syntactic Parallelism & Correlative Matrices

This table summarizes the core grammatical patterns of Parallel Structures that you must replicate flawlessly on your exam papers.

Conjunction Type	Formulas & Structure	Exam Application Example	Key Trap to Avoid
Coordinating Conjunctions	A + B + and / or + C (All must share the same part of speech)	He likes writing reports, managing staff, and dealing with clients.	Never mix gerunds with infinitives or plain nouns in a list (e.g., avoiding: running, to write, and files).
Correlative Conjunctions	Not only [X] but also [Y] Neither [X] nor [Y] (X and Y must be identical)	The union demanded not only to secure pension plans but also to obtain higher overtime pay.	Do not introduce a new subject or clause structure in [Y] if [X] starts with a simple infinitive.
Comparative Parallelism	[X] + rather than / as well as + [Y] (X and Y must be identical)	We prefer recruiting temporary workers rather than outsourcing our entire labor.	Avoid shifting from gerunds to base verbs after 'rather than'.

Tableau M mo 1.2: Phonetic Suffix Accentuation & Suffix Stress Shift Cheat Sheet

A handy reference guide mapping how word stress shifts dynamically during word family derivations.

Root Word	Suffix Added	Derived Word	Stress Position Shift	Phonetic Pronunciation
EM-ploy (Verb)	-ee (personal noun)	em-PLOY-ee	Shifts from 1st to 3rd syllable	/�m,plɔ�i:/ (Stress on '-ee')
EM-ploy (Verb)	-er (personal noun)	em-PLOY-er	Shifts from 1st to 2nd syllable	/�m'plɔ�.�r/
EM-ploy (Verb)	-ment (abstract noun)	em-PLOY-ment	Shifts from 1st to 2nd syllable	/�m'plɔ�.m�nt/
re-DUN-dant (Adjective)	-cy (abstract noun)	re-DUN-dan-cy	Remains on the 2nd syllable	/r�'d�n.d�n.si/
dis-MISS (Verb)	-al (action noun)	dis-MIS-sal	Remains on the 2nd syllable	/d�s'm�s.�l/
re-sign (Verb)	-ation (noun)	res-ig-NA-tion	Shifts to the penult (3rd syllable)	/,rez.�g'nei.f�n/